

Πλάτων ὁ κωμωδιοποιός (Ἀθηναῖος)

Plato the Comic Poet Between Old and Middle Comedy

eul_aid: efq

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Κωμωδία Ἀττική](#) [Attic Comedy](#)
Domain: [Κωμωδία](#) [Comedy](#)
Format: [Ἑμμετρος](#) [Verse](#)

Plato the Comic Poet was an Athenian playwright active in the late 5th and early 4th centuries BCE. He is a distinct figure from the philosopher Plato. His career spanned the transitional period between the politically charged Old Comedy and the subsequent style known as Middle Comedy.

According to ancient records, he was a prolific author, though the exact number of his works is uncertain; sources suggest he wrote around 28 to 30 comedies. His plays were typical of Old Comedy, featuring sharp political satire. Surviving titles, such as **Hyperbolus** and **Cleophon**, indicate he frequently targeted contemporary Athenian politicians and demagogues. Other works, like **The Sophists**, suggest he also satirized intellectual figures.

All of his complete plays are lost, and his work is known only through fragments quoted by later authors. Modern scholars regard Plato as a significant figure for understanding Athenian society and the evolution of comic theater. His politically engaged satire provides valuable evidence about the public figures and issues of his time. As a playwright whose career bridged two major comic styles, his fragments are important for studying the artistic shift away from direct political commentary in Athenian drama.

Works (5)

- [Ἐπίγραμμα](#) · [Epigram](#) · 10 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα τῆς Κωμικῆς Ἀφροδίτης](#) · [Fragments of Comic Aphrodite](#) · 32 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀδώνιδος καὶ Κινύρου](#) · [Fragments on Adonis and Cinyras](#) · 423 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἄργου καὶ Ὀλέθρου](#) · [Fragments on Argus and Destruction](#) · 6 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Κινύρου καὶ Ἀδωνιδος](#) · [Fragments on Cinyras and Adonis](#) · 311 passages